DIPOLE TYPE BY LENGTH

STEP 0 *l = antenna rod length (m); $c = 3\times10^8$ m/s*

$$\boxed{\lambda\ (\text{wavelength}) = \frac{c}{f} = \frac{3\times10^8}{f}\ (\text{m})}$$

l/λ	Type	Use formula
$< 1/50$	Hertzian (short)	HERTZIAN $S(R,\theta)$, $D=1.5$
$= 1/4$	Quarter-wave	ARB formula, $\pi l/\lambda = \pi/4$
$= 1/2$	Half-wave	half-wave shortcut, $D=1.64$, $R_{\text{rad}}=73\,\Omega$
$= 1$	Full-wave	ARB, $D = 2.41$, $R_{\text{rad}}=199\,\Omega$
other	Arbitrary	ARB formula

HERTZIAN DIPOLE — $S(R,\theta)$

Far-field E,H phasors *small $l \ll \lambda$*

$$\tilde{E}_\theta = \frac{jI_0kl\eta_0}{4\pi}\frac{e^{-jkR}}{R}\sin\theta,\quad \tilde{H}_\phi = \tilde{E}_\theta/\eta_0$$

Power density *$l/\lambda < 1/50$; far field*

$$S(R,\theta) = S_{\max}\sin^2\theta\ (\text{W/m}^2)$$

$$S_{\max} = \frac{\eta_0\,k^2I_0^2\,l^2}{32\pi^2R^2}\ (\text{W/m}^2)$$

Sym	Meaning (unit)	Sym	Meaning (unit)
l	rod length (m)	I_0	peak current (A)
R	obs. distance (m)	θ	angle from dipole axis (rad)
k	$2\pi/\lambda$ (rad/m)	η_0	$120\pi\approx377\,\Omega$
$S_{\max}$	max pwr density (W/m^2)		

Max @ broadside *$\perp$ to dipole axis = equator plane* $\theta_{\max} = \pi/2$; D *exact* $D=1.5$ (1.76 dB)

Total radiated power $P_{\text{rad}} = \frac{\eta_0\pi}{3}(I_0l/\lambda)^2$ (W)

ARBITRARY-LENGTH DIPOLE — $S(\theta)$

Power density at R *any l*

$$S(\theta) = \frac{15I_0^2}{\pi R^2}\left[\frac{\cos\!\left(\frac{\pi l}{\lambda}\cos\theta\right)-\cos\!\left(\frac{\pi l}{\lambda}\right)}{\sin\theta}\right]^2$$

At $\theta=0,\pi$: bracket is 0/0. L'Hôpital $\Rightarrow$ $S=0$ (no axial radiation). TI-36X Pro alt: evaluate bracket at $\theta=0.001$ rad $\rightarrow$ tiny $\rightarrow$ 0.

Normalized pattern *dimensionless* $F(\theta)=S(\theta)/S_{\max}$

COMMON ANGLES (deg $\leftrightarrow$ rad, trig values)

Conversion *multiply by $\pi/180$ or $180/\pi$*

$$\theta_{\text{rad}} = \theta_{\text{deg}}\cdot\frac{\pi}{180}\qquad \theta_{\text{deg}} = \theta_{\text{rad}}\cdot\frac{180}{\pi}$$

$^\circ$	rad	$\sin\theta$	$\cos\theta$	$\sin^2\theta$	$\cos^2\theta$
0	0	0	1	0	1
30	$\pi/6$	$1/2$	$\sqrt{3}/2$	$1/4$	$3/4$
45	$\pi/4$	$\sqrt{2}/2$	$\sqrt{2}/2$	$1/2$	$1/2$
60	$\pi/3$	$\sqrt{3}/2$	$1/2$	$3/4$	$1/4$
90	$\pi/2$	1	0	1	0
180	π	0	-1	0	1

Antenna formulas usually take θ in rad. RAD mode on calc.

LINEAR ANTENNA ARRAY

N identical elements along axis, spacing d, equal phase (broadside, $\theta_{max}=\pi/2$). Total pattern $S = S_e\cdot F_a$ (S_e = single elem).

Array factor (uniform, broadside) *$k = 2\pi/\lambda$, $\gamma = kd\cos\theta$*

$$F_a(\theta) = \frac{\sin^2(N\gamma/2)}{\sin^2(\gamma/2)};\quad F_a^{\max}=N^2 \text{ at } \theta=\pi/2$$

Normalize $F_a^{\text{norm}} = F_a/N^2$

HPBW (broadside, uniform) *use Nd, not $(N-1)d$*

$$\beta\approx 0.88\,\frac{\lambda}{Nd}\ (\text{rad}) = 50.8^\circ\cdot\frac{\lambda}{Nd}$$

Grating lobes appear if $d>\lambda$. Avoid.

BEAM PARAMETERS — β, Ω_p, D

Normalize *always start here*

$$F(\theta) = S(\theta)/S_{\max}\ (\text{unitless})$$

Beamwidth β at threshold X

Set $F(\theta_X)=X$, solve for θ_X; $\beta=2\theta_X$ (symmetric)

Threshold	$X=10^{\text{dB}/10}$	θ_X (Gauss. short-cut)
HPBW (-3 dB)	0.5	$\sqrt{\frac{\ln 2}{a}}$
-6 dB	0.25	$\sqrt{\frac{\ln 4}{a}}$
-10 dB	0.1	$\sqrt{\frac{\ln 10}{a}}$
any $F(\theta_X)$	any X	$F(\theta_X)=X$

Pattern solid angle Ω_p *recognize pattern, look up*

$$\Omega_p = \int_0^{2\pi}\!\!\int_0^{\pi}F(\theta)\sin\theta\,d\theta\,d\phi\ \ (\text{sr})$$

No ϕ dep.: $\Omega_p = 2\pi\int_0^\pi F(\theta)\sin\theta\,d\theta$.

θ is the integration variable — DON'T plug in a number for θ (e.g. $\theta_{1/2}$). Integrate over $\theta\in[0,\pi]$.

Pattern $F(\theta)$	Ω_p (sr)
Isotropic ($F=1$)	$4\pi\approx12.57$
Hertzian $\sin^2\theta$	$8\pi/3\approx8.38$
Half-wave dipole	≈ 7.66
Narrow Gauss $e^{-a\theta^2}$	$\pi/a=\pi\theta_{1/2}^2/\ln 2$
2-axis HPBW (aperture)	$\beta_{xz}\cdot\beta_{yz}$
Other (use integral)	numerical

TI-36X Pro: `[2nd][d/dx]` for $\int_\square^\square$, RAD mode, multiply by 2π.

Directivity D *always $D=4\pi/\Omega_p$; common shortcuts below*

$$D = \frac{4\pi}{\Omega_p}\quad(\text{unitless})\qquad D_{\text{dB}}=10\log_{10}D$$

WORD TRAP: "direction" = $\theta_{\max}$ (rad); "directivity" = D (unitless).

Dipoles $\rightarrow$ COMMON DIPOLE PARAMS table. Aperture: $D\approx4\pi A_p/\lambda^2$. 2-axis HPBW: $D\approx4\pi/(\beta_{xz}\beta_{yz})$. Circular: $D\approx4\pi/\beta^2$.

Gain (if asked) *ξ = rad. eff., $0<\xi\le1$*

$$G=\xi D\qquad G_{\text{dB}}=10\log_{10}G$$

Lossless / ideal antenna $\Rightarrow$ $G=D$.

COMMON DIPOLE PARAMETERS

Lossless ($\xi=1$): $G=D$.

Type	l	D	D_{dB}	R_{rad} (Ω)
Isotropic	N/A	1	0	—
Hertzian	$<\lambda/50$	1.5	1.76	$80\pi^2(l/\lambda)^2$
Half-wave	$\lambda/2$	1.64	2.15	73.2
Monopole	$\lambda/4$ (gnd)	1.64	2.15	36.6
Full-wave	λ	2.41	3.82	199

Half-wave: $P_{\text{rad}}=36.6I_0^2$ W. Monopole ($\lambda/4$ above ground): same patt. as half-wave but P_{rad}, R_{rad} halved.

ANTENNA AREAS (A_e, A_p)

Effective area *antenna's RX cross section; D from BEAM PARAMS or table above*

$$A_e = \frac{\lambda^2D}{4\pi}\ (\text{m}^2)$$

Physical cross section *wire dipole, diameter d; l see table above*

$$A_p = l\,d\ \ (\text{m}^2,\ \text{any dipole})$$

Inverse: D from A_e

$$D = \frac{4\pi A_e}{\lambda^2}\ (\text{unitless})$$

Thin wire: $A_e \gg A_p$ (e.g., Hertzian $A_e = 3\lambda^2/8\pi \approx 0.119\lambda^2$).

FRIIS TRANSMISSION FORMULA

For each antenna's G: if given by NAME ("half-wave dipole" etc.) $\rightarrow$ COMMON DIPOLE PARAMS ($G=D$, lossless). Else (dB/linear value given) $\rightarrow$ use as given (convert dB $\rightarrow$ linear).

Pwr density at RX, then RX pwr *G_t, G_r linear gains; $\lambda=c/f$*

$$S_r = \frac{G_tP_t}{4\pi R^2}\ (\text{W/m}^2);\quad \boxed{P_r = G_tG_r\left(\frac{\lambda}{4\pi R}\right)^2P_t}\ (\text{W})$$

Equivalent: $P_r = S_rA_{e,r}$.

Solve for R *max range*

$$R = \frac{\lambda}{4\pi}\sqrt{\frac{G_tG_rP_t}{P_r}}\ (\text{m})$$

Equivalent form using A_e *recv. area form*

$$P_r = \frac{G_tP_tA_{e,r}}{4\pi R^2},\quad G_r = \frac{4\pi A_{e,r}}{\lambda^2}$$

Free-space path loss: $L_{fs} = (4\pi R/\lambda)^2$, so $P_r = G_tG_rP_t/L_{fs}$.

Off-axis (patterns not aligned): multiply by $F_t(\theta_t,\phi_t)F_r(\theta_r,\phi_r)$, both = 1 when aligned.

Recipe 1. $\lambda=c/f$. 2. Convert any dB gain $\rightarrow$ linear: $G=10^{G_{\text{dB}}/10}$. 3. Get G_t, G_r by antenna type: dipole$\rightarrow$COMMON DIPOLE PARAMS; aperture$\rightarrow$APERTURE box; arbitrary $F\rightarrow$BEAM PARAMS. 4. Plug into Friis.

Use linear G, not dB. Convert FIRST.

dB $\leftrightarrow$ LINEAR

Works for any power-like quantity (G, D, P_r/P_t, SNR, ...):

$$X_{\text{dB}} = 10\log_{10}X_{\text{lin}}\qquad X_{\text{lin}} = 10^{X_{\text{dB}}/10}$$

dB	linear	dB	linear
0	1	10	10
3	2	13	20
6	4	20	100
7	5	30	1000
-3	0.5	-10	0.1

Memorize: 3 dB $\Leftrightarrow\times2$, 10 dB $\Leftrightarrow\times10$. Add dB = multiply linear.

For E-field / amplitude use $20\log$ not $10\log$ (power $\propto E^2$).

NOISE & SNR

Noise power *thermal noise into matched receiver*

$$P_N = k_B\,T_{\text{sys}}\,B\ (\text{W})$$

$k_B = 1.38\times10^{-23}$ J/K; T_{sys} system noise temp (K); B receiver bandwidth (Hz).

Signal-to-noise ratio

$$\text{SNR} = \frac{P_{\text{rec}}}{P_N}\ (\text{unitless})\qquad \text{SNR}_{\text{dB}}=10\log_{10}\frac{P_{\text{rec}}}{P_N}$$

Typical comm. link needs SNR > 10 dB for usable signal.

APERTURE ANTENNAS (horn, dish)

A_p physical aperture area (m^2); A_e effective area (m^2, $=\lambda^2D/4\pi$); β_{xz},β_{yz} HPBWs in two planes (rad); ℓ, d aperture side / diameter (m).

Directivity (any shape, uniform illum.)

$$D\approx\frac{4\pi A_p}{\lambda^2}\ (\text{unitless})\quad\Rightarrow\ A_e\approx A_p$$

Directivity from beamwidths *any aperture*

$$D\approx\frac{4\pi}{\beta_{xz}\beta_{yz}}\ (\text{use rad});\ \text{circular: } D\approx4\pi/\beta^2$$

HPBW and D by aperture shape *uniform illum.; β in rad*

Shape	A_p	HPBW (rad)	D (unitless)
Rect. $\ell_x\times\ell_y$	$\ell_x\ell_y$	$\beta_x\approx0.88\lambda/\ell_x$, $\beta_y\approx0.88\lambda/\ell_y$	$D\approx4\pi/(\beta_x\beta_y)$ $=4\pi\ell_x\ell_y/\lambda^2$
Square ℓ	ℓ^2	$\beta\approx0.88\lambda/\ell$	$D\approx4\pi/\beta^2 = 4\pi\ell^2/\lambda^2$
Circular (diam. d)	$\pi d^2/4$	$\beta\approx1.02\lambda/d$	$D\approx4\pi/\beta^2 = \pi^2d^2/\lambda^2$

Scaling (any ratio) *$D\propto A_p/\lambda^2$; $\beta\propto\lambda/\sqrt{A_p}$*

$$D_{\text{new}} = D_{\text{old}}\cdot\frac{A_{p,\text{new}}}{A_{p,\text{old}}}\cdot\left(\frac{f_{\text{new}}}{f_{\text{old}}}\right)^2$$

$$\beta_{\text{new}} = \beta_{\text{old}}\cdot\sqrt{\frac{A_{p,\text{old}}}{A_{p,\text{new}}}}\cdot\frac{f_{\text{old}}}{f_{\text{new}}}$$

If a parameter is unchanged, its ratio = 1. Examples: double area $\rightarrow$ $D\times2$, $\beta\times1/\sqrt{2}$; double freq $\rightarrow$ $D\times4$, $\beta\times1/2$.

DIPOLE

l — antenna length (m)
$\lambda=c/f$ (m); $c=3\times10^8$ m/s
I_0 — peak current (A)
$k=2\pi/\lambda$ (rad/m)
R — obs. dist. (m); θ from axis
$\eta_0=120\pi\approx377\,\Omega$
$S(R,\theta)$ — pwr density (W/m^2)

BEAM

$F(\theta)=S/S_{\max}$ (unitless)
a — coef. on θ^2 in Gaussian
β — HPBW (rad or $^\circ$)
Ω_p — pattern solid angle (sr)
$D=4\pi/\Omega_p$ — directivity
ξ rad. eff.; $G=\xi D$
$D_{\text{dB}} = 10\log_{10}D$; $D = 10^{D_{\text{dB}}/10}$

FRIIS / dB

P_t — power transmitted (W)
P_r — power received (W)
G_t — transmit gain (linear)
G_r — receive gain (linear)
$S_r=G_tP_t/(4\pi R^2)$ (W/m^2)
$P_r=G_tG_r(\lambda/4\pi R)^2P_t$
$G=10^{G_{\text{dB}}/10}$
$3\,\text{dB}=\times2, 10\,\text{dB}=\times10$
$P_N=k_BT_{\text{sys}}B$ (W)

APERTURE

A_p — physical area (m^2)
$A_e=\lambda^2D/(4\pi)$ (m^2)
$A_e\approx A_p$ for aperture
$D\approx4\pi A_p/\lambda^2$ (unitless)
$\beta\approx0.88\lambda/\ell$ (rect/sq.)
$\beta\approx1.02\lambda/d$ (circular)
$2A_p\Rightarrow2D,\ \beta/\sqrt{2}$

ARRAY

N — number of elements
d — spacing (m)
$\gamma=kd\cos\theta$
$F_a=\sin^2(N\gamma/2)/\sin^2(\gamma/2)$
$F_a^{\max}=N^2$ at $\theta=\pi/2$
$F_a^{\text{norm}}=F_a/N^2$
$\beta\approx0.88\lambda/(Nd)$ (broadside)